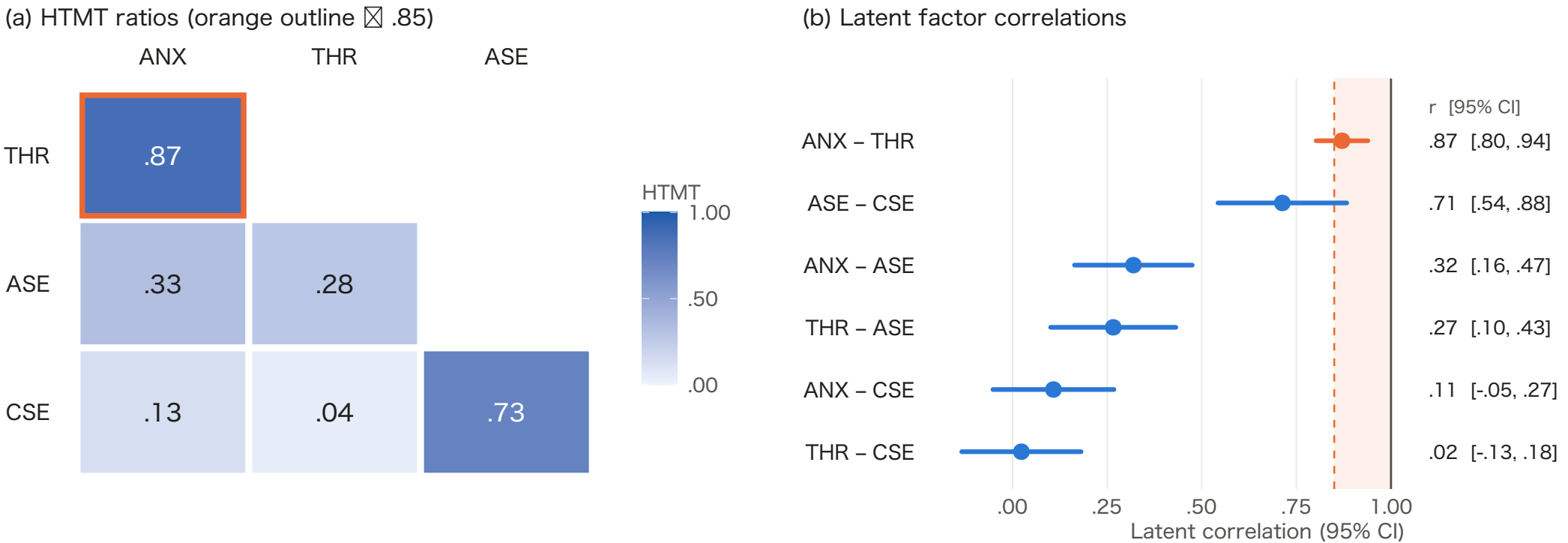
Discriminant validity: AI career anxiety is distinct from, but close to, threat appraisal

ANX and THR share a high latent correlation (r = .87, 95% CI [.80, .94]), yet the interval excludes 1.0 and a two-factor model fits better than a single merged factor ($\Delta \chi^2(1) = 21.57$, $p < .001$).



Note. HTMT computed from absolute item correlations (Henseler et al., 2015). The shaded band in panel (b) marks the .85 caution zone; a confidence interval that excludes 1.0 supports discriminant validity. Dashed orange line = .85, solid line = 1.0.